SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-29 Thursday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.75
USD/dmt
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-10-29 17:49:33 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-29 17:14:08 (UTC+8)

Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

682.0
yuan/mt
▲ +10.0 +1.49%
MTD avg **676.4**
As of Oct 29 · vs Oct 28

Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 29

Index	Value	Unit	Change	%	MTD avg
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily	654	yuan/wmt	▲ +4	+0.62%	657
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily	608	yuan/wmt	▲ +5	+0.83%	615
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily	817	yuan/wmt	▲ +6	+0.74%	818
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily	90.90	USD/dmt	▲ +1.25	+1.39%	90.23
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily	107.05	USD/dmt	▲ +0.55	+0.52%	108.41
SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily	797.44	yuan/mt	— 0.00	0.00%	806.37

Last 3 months

As of Oct 29 · vs Oct 28

Key View

Futures and spot extend their recovery as port stocks ease; sustained buying remains essential

The price recovery continued today alongside a modest improvement in port inventories. DCE most-traded closed at 682.0 yuan/mt, up 1.49%; the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices rose to 654, 608 and 817 yuan/wmt. The seaborne indices reached USD 90.90/dmt for the 61% and 107.05 for the 65%, with all 12 brands higher. Mainstream port quotations also broadly increased, producing relatively aligned price direction.

Ten-port stocks fell 618,100 mt on Oct 29 from the preceding survey, with declines in fines, concentrates and pellets and a small rise in lump. Stock absorption may reflect both arrivals and collections rather than demand alone. Two consecutive increases in hot metal support baseline consumption, while raw-material stock management, finished-steel margins and environmental measures still influence purchasing schedules.

The near-term test is whether stronger prices attract and sustain physical transactions. Buying that improves alongside orders could provide a firmer basis for the rebound. If the move mainly reflects offers while restocking remains limited, high supply flows and profitability constraints could restrict upside. Higher freight also calls for assessing costs against contracts and settlement conditions, favouring a cautious, range-bound view.

Today's Highlights

- **Futures and spot prices extended their recovery.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **682.0 yuan/mt**, up 10.0 yuan (+1.49%) from Oct 28. Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 650 yuan/wmt and Mac Fines were 657, each up 10 yuan; Carajas Fines rose 7 yuan to 822 and PB Lump rose 5 yuan to 820.
- **Seaborne indices and all 12 brand quotations rose.** The 61% index was **USD 90.90/dmt**, up 1.25 (+1.39%), and the 65% was **107.05**, up 0.55 (+0.52%). All brands increased against the Oct 28 report, with PB Fines at 91.20, Newman Fines 90.35 and Mac Fines 90.40 USD/dmt.
- **All three port indices increased.** The 61%, 58% and 65% indices were 654, 608 and 817 yuan/wmt, up 4, 5 and 6 yuan. The 65%-58% spread widened from 208 to 209 yuan/wmt, while the seaborne grade spread narrowed from USD 16.85 to 16.15/dmt.
- **Ten-port stocks declined modestly.** Total inventory was **104.0353 million mt** on Oct 29, down 618,100 mt (-0.59%) from Oct 22. Fines, concentrates and pellets fell by 261,100, 203,800 and 157,500 mt, respectively, while lump edged up 4,300 mt.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-29 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	650	▲ +10 +1.56%	645	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	650	▲ +10 +1.56%	646	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	657	▲ +10 +1.55%	649	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	700	▲ +10 +1.45%	696	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	825	▲ +10 +1.23%	834	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	512	▲ +10 +1.99%	507	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	822	▲ +7 +0.86%	822	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	820	▲ +5 +0.61%	828	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-29 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-28
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	87.65	▲ +1.20 +1.39%	86.45
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	89.00	▲ +1.00 +1.14%	88.00
PB Fines 62% Daily	91.20	▲ +1.20 +1.33%	90.00
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	90.35	▲ +1.25 +1.40%	89.10
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	90.40	▲ +1.15 +1.29%	89.25
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	87.70	▲ +0.85 +0.98%	86.85
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	107.20	▲ +1.25 +1.18%	105.95
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	98.20	▲ +1.30 +1.34%	96.90
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	97.75	▲ +1.25 +1.30%	96.50
RTX Fines 61% Daily	87.35	▲ +1.10 +1.28%	86.25
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	90.45	▲ +1.05 +1.17%	89.40
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	81.05	▲ +0.45 +0.56%	80.60

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.23	-6.50%	-14.2%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	108.41	-5.26%	-11.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	657	-5.05%	-19.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	818	-2.55%	-9.1%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	615	-4.99%	-15.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	806.37	-3.84%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 90.90/dmt (+1.39%) and the 65% was 107.05 (+0.52%), narrowing their spread from USD 16.85 to 16.15/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 654, 608 and 817 yuan/wmt, up 4, 5 and 6 yuan.

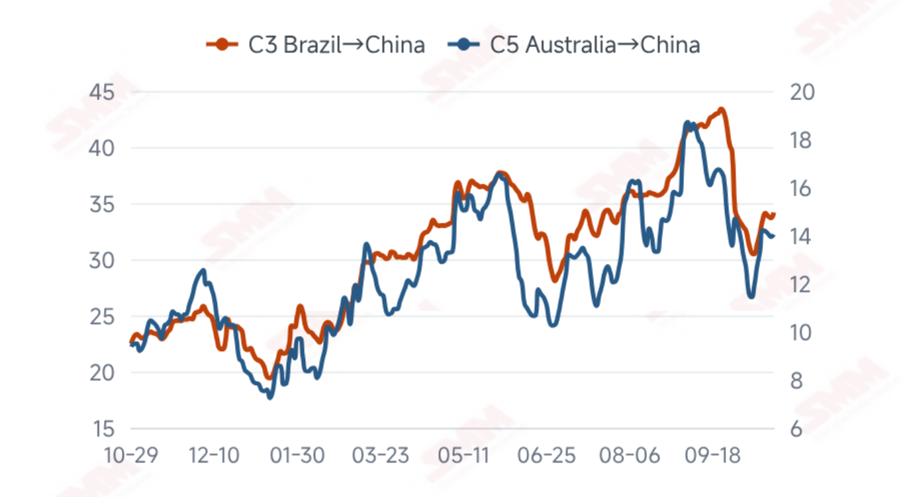
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

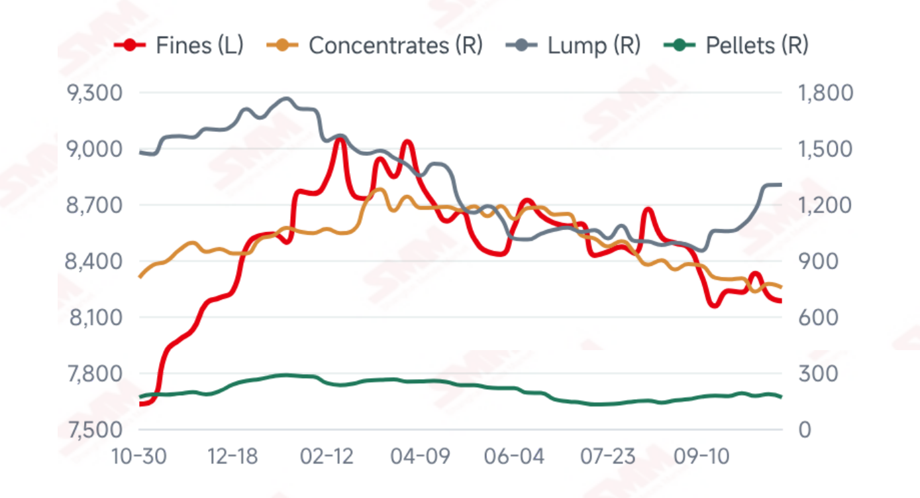
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



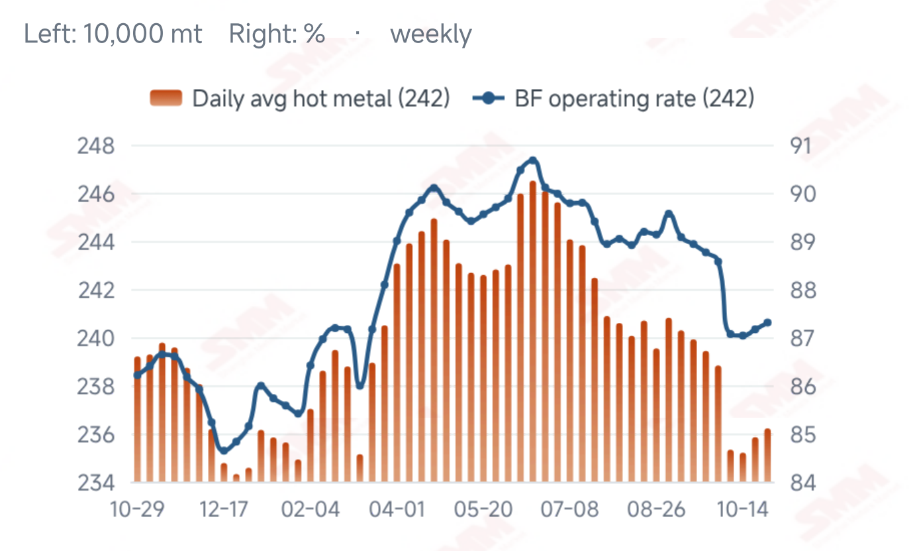
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



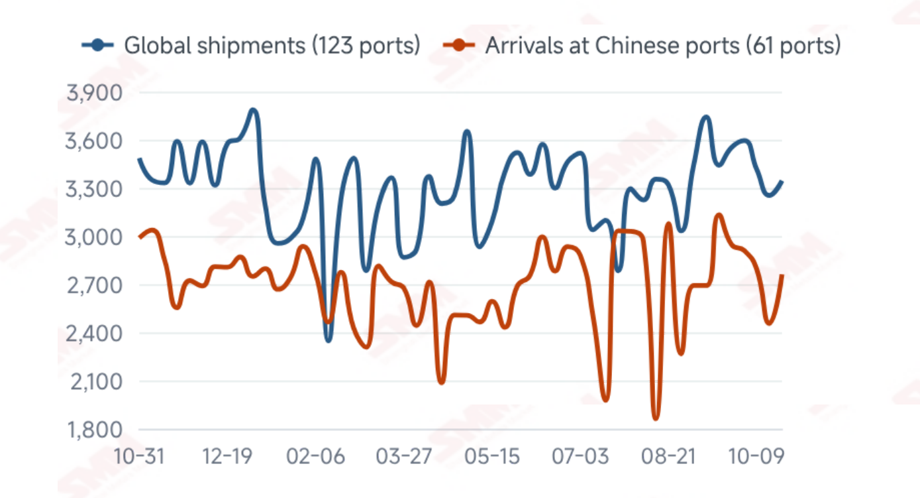
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 682.0 yuan/mt, up 1.49% from the previous session. Qingdao PB Fines were 650, Newman Fines 650, Mac Fines 657, BRBF 700, Newman Lump 825 and SSF 512 yuan/wmt, each up 10 yuan; Carajas Fines rose 7 yuan to 822 and PB Lump rose 5 yuan to 820. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 90.75/dmt, timestamped Oct 29, 17:14:08 (UTC+8). SMM's daily review described consecutive price gains but still limited overall trading.

Drivers Domestic futures, port indices and seaborne quotations strengthened together, extending the previous recovery. The seaborne 61% index rose more than the 65%, narrowing the grade spread, while the port high-low spread widened slightly. Structural performance therefore differs across markets. Firmer prices may encourage offers, but durability still depends on mill purchases, transaction volumes and resource availability.

Demand The latest 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3621 million mt on Oct 28, up 3,700 mt from Oct 21, and a blast furnace operating rate of 87.30%. Two consecutive increases support baseline consumption, while discretionary restocking remains constrained by orders, profitability and existing mill stocks. Environmental restrictions and maintenance schedules may affect subsequent production, leaving actual demand in focus.

Inventory & supply Ten-port stocks were 104.0353 million mt on Oct 29, down 618,100 mt (-0.59%) from Oct 22. Fines at 81.8182 million mt, concentrates at 7.5304 million mt and pellets at 1.6715 million mt fell by 261,100, 203,800 and 157,500 mt, respectively. Lump rose 4,300 mt to 13.0152 million mt. The drawdown may reflect arrivals, unloading and mill collections together rather than one demand factor. Latest global shipments and Chinese arrivals, for the week to Oct 23, were 33.4494 and 27.6076 million mt.

Cost & margin Oct 28 freight was USD 34.17/mt for C3, up 1.49% from the previous reading, and 14.03 for C5, up 0.72%. Higher ore prices and freight may raise procurement costs for some cargoes, while stronger port selling prices support receipts. Net margins still depend on contracts, exchange rates and settlement timing; one day's price direction does not establish a broad return to profit for mills or traders. SMM's assessment published Oct 29 showed the period's average import margin turning positive at 1.53 yuan/mt from -4.89, an improvement of 6.42 yuan. This import trading measure does not establish a return to profit for mills or coke producers.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices The Domestic Ore Composite Price Index held at 797.44 yuan/mt on Oct 29. SMM's current Tangshan brief quoted 66% concentrate at 885–890 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive ex-works basis, down 5–10 yuan. The regional quotation and national composite measure different markets.

Supply & demand SMM's Tangshan brief described low mining and beneficiation activity, little progress in private-mine restarts and tight supply. Mill losses and pressure on bids remained strong. The purchasing response to marginal production improvement still needs to be assessed against regional resources, orders and blending costs.

Outlook SMM expects Tangshan concentrate prices to remain range-bound near term. Persistent resource tightness alongside stronger buying could support offers, while limited recovery in mill margins and orders could constrain upside. Heating-season environmental maintenance remains a prospective risk rather than evidence of widespread restrictions already in effect.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

- DCE, all five MMi indices and all 12 seaborne brands increased.
- Daily hot metal rose for two consecutive periods, improving baseline consumption.
- Ten-port stocks fell 618,100 mt from Oct 22.
- Most port brand quotations increased, extending the price recovery.

▼ Bearish factors

- Sustained buying still needs support from end-user orders and mill margins.
- Latest Chinese arrivals rose 12.47% WoW, keeping subsequent supply flows in focus.
- Higher C3 and C5 freight may increase some procurement costs.
- Environmental restrictions and maintenance could affect subsequent production.

Flash News

- Coarse Ore Powder Destocking and Freight Support Drive Consecutive Gains in Ore Prices, but Trading Volume Fails to Expand [SMM Iron Ore Daily Review] ↗
  2026-10-29
- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrates prices in the Tangshan area may consolidate ↗
  2026-10-29
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261029 ↗
  2026-10-29
- Record sales, negative margin: Champion Iron's Q2 FY27 net realized price falls 30% [SMM Iron Ore] ↗
  2026-10-29
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian HRC Holds at USD 515/mt FOB as Export Prices Come Under Pressure Again ↗
  2026-10-29
- [SMM Steel] India Domestic Steel Market Remains Sluggish ↗
  2026-10-29

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